

04-01 Summary of the D&D Session: “No Loose Ends” Investigation

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SESSION SUMMARY3:00 AM Investigation

Investigation: "No Loose Ends"

Pursuit and interrogation of the "Friendly Face" cult informant.

Interrogation Findings

THE OPERATION

Controlled by Sylvie; involves ~20 townsfolk.

Processing center located at a nearby farm run by Bill Tidewater.

Core site: The Black Spire located in the swamp.

TACTICAL INTELLIGENCE

Assailants are likely clones; target was killed by his own double.

Trap bypass: Knock three times to neutralize glyphs.

Informant Assassinated

Target killed via crossbow bolt to the head by his clone.

Status: Terminated

CRITICAL THREAT ENCOUNTERED

7th Level Fireball Ambush

Triggered by a Magic Mouth taunt linked to a Glyph of Warding hidden under a rug.

Delayed BlastArcane Trap

Underground Smuggling Grid

6 Earthen TunnelsSaltwater Current

1. City Docks

Exits near the Mayweather.
Heavy scent of gillmen detected.

2. Farm Supply

Surfaces in a warehouse and connects to the remote farm still.

3. Noble District

Ends in a fancy wine cellar leading to magical darkness.

4. Safe House

Short path to the secondary safe house via a trapped hatch.

Tactical Execution

Arcane Scouting

Used an arcane eye to probe house interiors and tunnel paths safely.

Remote Disarmament

Mage hand triggered powder traps and poison dart mechanisms at range.

Invisibility Ambush

Invisibility and Thaumaturgy used to terrorize the target into confession.

Critical Next Steps

B

Verify tunnel sizes and rotted floor areas.

@Bastion

C

Neutralize high-level Glyphs of Warding.

@Celestine

S

Monitor the Mayweather and ship activities.

@Seven

The players conducted a late-night investigation into a cult-affiliated individual known as the “friendly face.” After navigating a series of complex traps to infiltrate his hideout and discovering a vast underground tunnel network, they located him in a second safe house. A tense interrogation revealed critical intelligence about the cult’s smuggling operations, cloning activities, and key locations before the target was assassinated by his own clone.

Reconnaissance and Planning

The session began on the party's ship at 3 a.m., with the group deciding their next move while monitoring the mysterious ship, the *Mayweather*, known to be carrying strange chemicals. With time to kill before businesses like the Smoked Eel Tavern would open in the afternoon, the party resolved to pursue a "loose end": the man known as the "friendly face" who had previously escaped them. They recognized he had direct connections to the cult, having been paid to confront them, and could possess valuable information on their whereabouts. The group agreed to attempt diplomacy and interrogation first, with the primary goal of gathering intelligence, though they acknowledged the high probability of a violent outcome.

Upon reaching the target's last known location, the party employed an arcane eye to scout the single-story house. The magical probe revealed a ransacked interior consisting of two rooms. The first was an entryway with a card table, and the second was a completely disheveled back room with an open, glassless window. The state of the house suggested it had been thoroughly searched, but there were no signs of the target, a struggle, or any blood. The party relayed these findings, concluding that someone had likely been there looking for the man or that he had left in a great hurry.

House Infiltration and Trap Disablement

Adopting a cautious approach, the party split into two teams to breach the booby-trapped house. The front team, consisting of Seven, Crystal, and Macarius, focused on the main entrance, while the back team of Bastion, Celestine, and Hunt approached the rear. The front team identified a mechanical powder trap on a boarded-up window, which they successfully triggered from a safe distance using a `mage hand` spell. They also discovered the front door handle was rigged to fall off.

Simultaneously, the back team found that the rear window's glass was broken outwards and a similar powder trap on the windowsill had already been sprung. As the infiltration continued, the party discovered that the interior door connecting the two rooms was also trapped with a poison dart mechanism linked to the handle. Again using `mage hand`, they triggered the trap safely. An analysis of the dart revealed it was coated with the same hallucinogen-laced poison commonly used by the cult, confirming a connection. The floor in the back room was noted to be spongy and rotted, and a crate bearing the cult's symbol was found to be filled with soil.

The Ambush and Discovery of the Tunnel Network

As the party converged in the trashed back room, their search led them to a rug in the center of the floor. Upon lifting it, they triggered a sophisticated magical ambush. A `magic mouth` spell delivered a taunting message from their target, which in turn activated a `glyph of warding` that unleashed a powerful, seventh-level delayed blast fireball. Several party members were caught in the explosion, sustaining significant damage, while others managed to evade the blast.

The explosion not only caused the room to begin burning but also blew open a hidden trapdoor that was concealed beneath the rug. The fire was quickly extinguished by a `ray of frost`. The investigation revealed that the crate of soil discovered earlier was the source of a desecrated, necrotic aura that was actively rotting the wood in the room, which paradoxically kept it from burning. This discovery confirmed a strong magical and likely sinister presence. The now-open trapdoor revealed a ladder descending into darkness, leading the party to a secret underground tunnel system.

Exploration of the Underground Tunnels

Descending into the trapdoor, the party found themselves at the entrance to a complex network of six earthen tunnels, with about an inch of cold saltwater on the floor. They began a systematic exploration to map out the network and determine its purpose. By observing the water's current and using magical scouting, they uncovered that the tunnels served as a sophisticated smuggling grid connecting several key locations:

- One tunnel led to an exit grate beneath the city docks, emerging near the party's own ship and the *Mayweather*. The area reeked of gillmen, suggesting their involvement.
- Another path surfaced in a warehouse and continued onward to a remote farm, where several people were seen inside the farmhouse.
- A third, very long tunnel ended in a fancy wine cellar, which led to a door that opened into a room filled with impenetrable magical darkness.
- A fourth, shorter tunnel terminated at a ladder leading up to a locked hatch.

Two of the six tunnels were deemed less traveled and were not immediately explored. The discoveries confirmed the existence of a widespread, clandestine operation for moving goods and personnel throughout the area, unseen by the general populace.

Confrontation, Interrogation, and Assassination

The party decided to investigate the shortest tunnel, which ended at a hatch. They discovered it was magically trapped with another high-level **glyph of warding**. After two failed attempts to dispel the magic, a character successfully defaced the glyph, neutralizing the trap. Peeking through the hatch, they found themselves in a room identical to the first safe house, where they heard breathing.

The party executed a stealthy ambush, with several members turning invisible. They found their target—the “friendly face”—asleep. They subdued him and began an intense interrogation, using magical intimidation such as **thaumaturgy** to change the lighting and create disembodied voices. Under duress, the man confessed a wealth of information:

- **The Cult’s Operation:** He works for Sylvie, smuggling chemicals, soil, and sometimes sick people to a still located on a nearby farm. This has been ongoing for at least three months.
- **Key Locations:** The farm serves as a processing center. He also confirmed the existence of The Black Spire in the swamp, where he has seen Sylvie.
- **Personnel:** About twenty townsfolk are involved, including a man named Bill Tidewater, who lives at the farm.
- **Clones:** He claimed his instructions were only to scare the party off, and he was not involved in the subsequent lethal attack. This strongly implies the attackers were clones, a known tactic of the cult.
- **Traps:** The magical glyphs are bypassed by knocking three times, a secret he and his associates use.

As the interrogation concluded, three loud knocks were heard at the front door. The party forced their captive to answer. When he opened the door, he was confronted by his own exact double, who promptly shot him in the head with a hand crossbow, killing him instantly. The session ended with the party facing the assassin clone, having lost their informant but gained critical leads on the cult’s entire operation.

Action Items

@Bastion

- [] Take out the bell and put it in your hand - [TBD]
- [] Use insight on the tunnels to see if any are too small or short - [TBD]
- [] Hop up on the window and make it look like I fall in, stepping on the wall with Crocs of climbing - [TBD]
- [] Check the ground near the window for rotted areas or trap doors - [TBD]

- [] Crouch over the sleeping man with his face covered in ink and tap him a little bit with his staff - [TBD]

@Celestine

- [] Check for traps - [TBD]
- [] Peek her head up and just look around - [TBD]
- [] Stop, pop her head back down - [TBD]
- [] Pop back down and report that it seems almost identical to the house they were just in, with the same trap on the same looking door - [TBD]
- [] Move in stealth - [TBD]
- [] Go up first (to the hatch) - [TBD]
- [] Go invisible - [TBD]
- [] Keep an eye and ear out for anything else that happens or for backup - [TBD]
- [] Play “floor is lava” and go onto furniture, specifically the sturdiest crate - [TBD]
- [] I’ll go first (to dispel the magic on the hatch) - [TBD]
- [] Try to find the object (source of abjuration magic) - [TBD]
- [] Start walking towards the house - [TBD]
- [] Keep an eye out just in case it’s a trap, and try to surround the house - [TBD]
- [] I’ll go in the back to chase if he runs - [TBD]
- [] Book down one (tunnel) - [TBD]
- [] Send the eye down another (tunnel) - [TBD]
- [] Come back in three minutes - [TBD]
- [] Send the eye to look right now - [TBD]
- [] I’ll go down the one where the water, the piece of paper, is moving, following the current - [TBD]
- [] I’ll do the next one (tunnel) - [TBD]
- [] Send Quattro down a second one (tunnel) - [TBD]
- [] I’ll just go down the other channel - [TBD]

- [TBD]
- [] Go towards the light - [TBD]
- [] Have the light go up and out through the floorboard - [TBD]
- [] Have the eye pop up and look around - [TBD]
- [] Look for the spiral markings on the crates - [TBD]
- [] Go back down the tunnel and see what I see - [TBD]
- [] Go out the front to look - [TBD]
- [] Send the eye towards the house - [TBD]
- [] Bring the eye back - [TBD]
- [] Sprint down the next one (pinky tunnel) - [TBD]
- [] Stay at Mac's speed - [TBD]
- [] Continue down (the tunnel) - [TBD]
- [] Go a little further - [TBD]
- [] Continue forward; just stay quiet - [TBD]
- [] Move up and smell fishmen - [TBD]
- [] Go down the other one, peek through the hatch, see if I can figure out where it is, or what's there, not going to go much farther than that, and then meet you guys back at the smoldering house - [TBD]

@Crystal

- [] I'll do the arcane check - [TBD]
- [] Check the window - [TBD]
- [] Make an investigation check to know what manner of trap it is - [TBD]
- [] Check the front door again because of the trap on the window - [TBD]
- [] Head towards the secondary (interior) back door to check it - [TBD]
- [] Look inside (the house) - [TBD]
- [] Enter the room - [TBD]
- [] Keep an eye out for those kinds of traps - [TBD]
- [] Roll insight to figure out what happened in this room - [TBD]
- [] Check under the rug - [TBD]
- [] Go towards Macarius and say, "Hey, that's fun a bit" - [TBD]

- [] Go towards Mac and be like, "Hey, that's fun a bit" - [TBD]
- [] Run towards the trap door - [TBD]
- [] Look at everybody else who's still here - [TBD]
- [] Go find them - [TBD]
- [] Leave through the front, run around towards the back, and head out thirty-forty yards to see if I see any footprints of something that broke through the window and ran, or if it was a distraction - [TBD]
- [] Go down one of the other tunnels with Bastion - [TBD]
- [] Go back - [TBD]
- [] Remove it and take it with us (the hatch) - [TBD]
- [] Go check the hatch - [TBD]
- [] Go check the other one (tunnel) - [TBD]
- [] Allow the target to get up and get the delivery - [TBD]

@Fabio

- [] Create an illusion to sketch Bill Tidewater's face based on the target's description - [TBD]
- [] Keep an eye out for other instances of this type of magic - [TBD]
- [] Ask the target where the still is - [TBD]
- [] Continue to ask questions to gather more information - [TBD]
- [] Go check the hatch - [TBD]
- [] Look for traps, both physical and magical, on the hatch - [TBD]
- [] Dispel the magical trap on the hatch - [TBD]
- [] Figure out how to properly deface the glyph without setting it off - [TBD]
- [] Use mage hand to open the hatch - [TBD]
- [] Use my book for assistance with arcane - [TBD]
- [] Ask questions to the target - [TBD]
- [] Ask the target what he was saying to the party (his catchphrase) - [TBD]
- [] Ask the target why he can't move and what the party did to him - [TBD]
- [] Ask the target about his connection with the cult - [TBD]
- [] Inquire about who pays him - [TBD]
- [] Ask about Sylvie's location and name - [TBD]
- [] Ask what Sylvie pays him for - [TBD]
- [] Ask how long this has been going on - [TBD]
- [] Ask the target who sets his traps - [TBD]
- [] Ask the target if he knows who would know how to do magic for the traps - [TBD]

- [] Ask the target about the farm's defenses (people, guards, weapons, numbers) - [TBD]
- [] Ask the target how to get into the still - [TBD]
- [] Ask the target what the warehouse near the farm is used for and why they were told to stay away - [TBD]
- [] Ask the target about the "middle finger" tunnel and why they were told not to use it - [TBD]
- [] Ask the target who delivers the crate - [TBD]
- [] Tell the target he will be getting the delivery and bringing it to the party, and that disembodied voices will rip out his eyeballs if he doesn't comply - [TBD]

@Hop

- [] Check the ground near the window for trap doors or other ways out - [TBD]
- [] Look for any tracks of someone running - [TBD]
- [] Check the other door in the back - [TBD]
- [] Take a look at the other side of the door from this side - [TBD]
- [] Look for grooves in the tunnels - [TBD]

@Jarrett

- [] Try and scout out that like house that he was hiding in - [TBD]

@Macarius

- [] I'll do the perception check - [TBD]
- [] Try to go in (to the house) - [TBD]
- [] Use his medicine or poisoner's kit to check the type of poison on the dart - [TBD]
- [] Use Medicine or a Poisoner's Kit to check the type of poison with advantage - [TBD]
- [] Make a Religion check - [TBD]
- [] Poke Hop and say, "Please don't poison me," then channel divine power to the goddess - [TBD]
- [] Check what kind of water it is, saltwater or from the ground, or if there's a way to tell if it's going towards the ocean - [TBD]
- [] Make a nature check or survival check - [TBD]
- [] Take out a notebook, rip out a piece of paper, and let it sit on the water to see if it goes anywhere - [TBD]
- [] Ask if there's any life in the water and communicate with them - [TBD]
- [] Ask if any big creatures like mice that look like humans came this way - [TBD]

- [] Tell them to swim away from me if they have, or come closer if they haven't - [TBD]
- [] Relay to Sebastian that there are people - [TBD]
- [] Let everyone know that there are definitely people this way, so we could go further or come back and revisit this area - [TBD]
- [] Make perception checks - [TBD]
- [] Let Bastion know that the Gillmen aren't down this way - [TBD]
- [] Try to dispel it (the magic on the hatch) - [TBD]
- [] Use Thaumaturgy to change the color of the candle light to blood red - [TBD]
- [] Do the double voice thing and say "be not afraid" - [TBD]
- [] Open up all seven eyes - [TBD]

@Seven

- [] Ask Uncle Pavo and Yosela if they saw anything weird or sketchy out of sorts with the other boat - [TBD]
- [] Go to the house the friendly face went into - [TBD]
- [] Go once we get like maybe a block or so away - [TBD]
- [] Have Quanco use the eye and send the eye into the building to see if I can find him - [TBD]
- [] Have the eye like literally look for the guy - [TBD]
- [] Continue to eye forward right like into the secondary door and then just kind of like slip it under the like the door frame - [TBD]
- [] Relay that message - [TBD]
- [] Do like the small illusion so you guys can see what I see - [TBD]
- [] Go in group one with whoever wants to roll with me to the front of the house and the front door - [TBD]
- [] Have group two going through the back door, trying to catch a move in the house - [TBD]
- [] Put a drop - [TBD]
- [] Look for traps, both physical and magical - [TBD]
- [] Tell everyone to back away from the window - [TBD]
- [] Try to cast `mage hand` to open the window, while Macarius and Crystal back up - [TBD]
- [] Look at the white powder - [TBD]
- [] Scope out the room for anything that's a mess, any items of interest, a trap door, or a hidey-hole spot - [TBD]
- [] Let the group know that the front door and window were trapped, and this door is also trapped - [TBD]
- [] Use mage hand to try and open the doorknob - [TBD]

- [] Tell Macarius and Crystal to hug the walls - [TBD]
- [] Let everybody know there is a trap door going in - [TBD]
- [] Jump down to see what I can see - [TBD]
- [] Send the eye down there - [TBD]
- [] Look for footprints - [TBD]
- [] Cast light to make it easier - [TBD]
- [] Make a U-turn and go back, looking out through the trap door - [TBD]
- [] Tell compatriots that there seems to be a tunnel system hewn out of soil, with six different directions - [TBD]
- [] Have him try and scout the boat, see if there's anyone inside - [TBD]
- [] Relay that he's hit some type of barrier and can't see anything; it's just all black and not dark black - [TBD]
- [] Keep the message communication open - [TBD]
- [] Communicate that they've been down there for ten-fifteen minutes - [TBD]
- [] Ping out every minute or so - [TBD]
- [] Mage hand it open (the hatch) - [TBD]

@So

- [] Go in the back with Celestine to cover him - [TBD]

@Unnamed speaker

- [] Do a detect magic spell to see if anything flares up - [TBD]
- [] Do a detect magic - [TBD]
- [] Start walking towards the house - [TBD]
- [] Keep Quattro outside across the street, keeping an eye on the front of the house - [TBD]
- [] Go into the front of the house - [TBD]
- [] Go into the back of the house - [TBD]
- [] Drop down on top of Crystal and try to pull her out - [TBD]
- [] Use Ray of Frost to try and get the fire out in the room - [TBD]
- [] Find that [magic weapon] and put it in the dungeon area - [TBD]
- [] Check the window - [TBD]
- [] Tell everyone to back away from the window - [TBD]
- [] Try to use mage hand to open the window and activate the trap from a safe distance - [TBD]
- [] Check under the rug - [TBD]
- [] Poke Hop and say, "Please don't poison me," then channel divine power to heal him - [TBD]

- ☐ Run towards the trap door - [TBD]